

FESTIVAL

A Blessed UNION

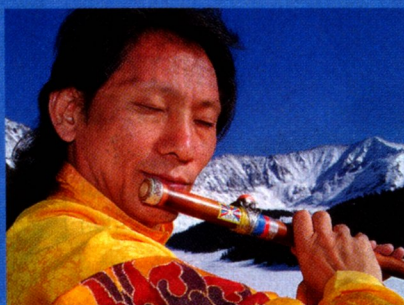
The Sacred Arts Festival celebrates personal communion with the creator. Organised by The Attic, a cultural organisation, it combines performances, film shows and walks to religious places. In Delhi from February 13.



GIREESH GV/www.indiatodayimages.com

Aruna Sairam Known for her versatility, she can combine both Hindustani and Carnatic music seamlessly. Sairam adapts her style to the various local forms in supplication to temples and deities. From Goddess Kali's prayers in Kolkata, to the songs of the boat people in Ganga, to Mira's bhajans, her voice has an unusual timbre which gives it a special quality.

Nawang Khechog The Tibetan flutist and a Grammy nominee, Khechog says his music is not for entertainment but "for the soul". It is the music of a monk who lived for 11 years as a hermit under the direct spiritual guidance of the Dalai Lama. He plays some compositions that mix earthy Tibetan chants with ethereal horns.



Al Tannoura The philosophy that the universe stems from the same point of rotation has been directly translated into the rotational whirling of the dervishes of the Egyptian Sufis. The verses that accompany this dance form echo a distinct Egyptian understanding of life and the universe, making the dance group Al Tannoura an interesting mixture of religious ritual and popular folk.

David Hykes and the Harmonic choir

David Hykes is one of the pioneers of modern sacred music. Specific to the vast steppes of Central Asia and Siberia, throat singing or harmonic singing allows the singer to create more than one pitch at the same time by changing the shape of the resonant cavities of the mouth. The five-member choir is sure to elevate your spirit.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit



A STILL FROM THE PLAY

THEATRE

Child's Play

Robinson and Crusoe, begins where Daniel Defoe's classic ends. The play has been created as part of Ranga Shankara's AHA-Theatre for Children programme. Directed by Gracias Devaraj from Germany, the play dwells on the changing times where the men meet as equals irrespective of their cultural backgrounds unlike in Defoe's novel where it was inevitable that the white conqueror would find himself a native slave. The play has all the ingredients to enthrall children, with music, fights and games. In schools in Bangalore this month and at Ranga Shankara from March 20. by Nirmala Ravindran

FESTIVAL

Glove DOLLS

What The Ishara International Puppet Festival showcases the revival of the traditional art form of puppetry to appeal to the contemporary audiences.

Who Puppeteers from various countries like Brazil, Iran, Israel, Switzerland and Italy will converge on a platform to exhibit traditional folk art with a touch of modernity, focusing on topics relevant to the current times. The festival kicked off with the act, *A Touch of Light*, by the Train Theatre group in Israel.

When and Where From February 13 At NCPA, Mumbai. by Mitali Patel